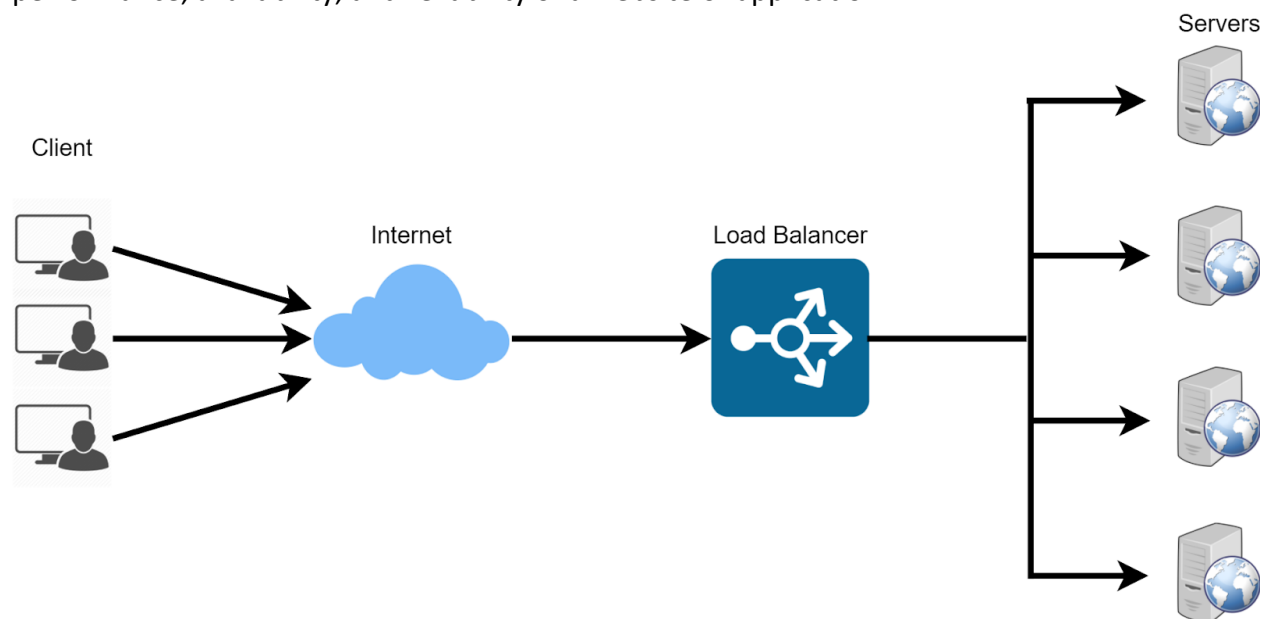


## ADC (Application Delivery Controller):

To understand Application Delivery Controllers (ADCs) better, it's useful to first learn about load balancers. This is because ADCs are like enhanced load balancers, offering extra features to make applications run faster and more securely.

### Load Balancer:

A load balancer is a device or software that helps distribute incoming network traffic across multiple servers to ensure that no single server becomes overloaded. This helps improve the performance, availability, and reliability of a website or application.



### Application Delivery Controller (ADC):

An **Application Delivery Controller (ADC)** is a smart network device that helps manage and speed up web applications. It sits between users and servers to balance traffic, improve performance, and enhance security.

An ADC is an advanced version of a load balancer, offering more comprehensive traffic management and optimization. It ensures smooth delivery of applications and improves the user experience.

ADC is a multitasking tool that makes apps faster, more reliable, and safer. It's like a combination of a traffic security guard, and speed booster for web applications. While traditional load balancers focus on distributing traffic, ADCs add layers of optimization, security, and resilience, making them essential for modern web services.

**In short, all ADCs are load balancers, but not all load balancers are ADCs.**

## ADC Features:

FortiADC is designed to provide advanced load balancing, security, performance optimization, and high availability for web applications, making it a powerful tool for improving user experience and network efficiency.

- o **Load Balancing:** Like a load balancer, but more advanced with added features.
- o **SSL Offloading:** Handles encryption to reduce server load.
- o **Compression:** Speeds up data transfer by compressing files.
- o **Web Application Firewall (WAF):** Protects against cyber-attacks targeting web apps.
- o **Application Acceleration:** Improves the speed and performance of applications.
- o **Speed Boost:** Uses caching and compression to make applications faster.
- o **Security:** Protects against cyber threats with features like firewalls and attack prevention.
- o **IPS (Intrusion Prevention System):** Protects against cyber threats.
- o **Layer 4 and Layer 7 Load Balancing:** Operates at both the transport and application layers, allowing it to manage different types of traffic more efficiently.
- o **Real-Time Visibility:** Offers detailed insights into traffic patterns, server health, and performance, helping administrators make informed decisions about load balancing and traffic management.
- o **DDoS Protection:** Includes protection against Distributed Denial of Service (DDoS) attacks, safeguarding applications and infrastructure.
- o **Access Control:** Allows administrators to configure fine-grained access controls for better security.

